

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**-----X
SAUL ALMONTE,

Plaintiffs.

-against-

**THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GRAZIADIO
(Tax Registry #966605) and P.O. "JOHN DOE I",**Defendants.
-----X**Index No.**Plaintiffs designate
Bronx County as the
place of trial.The basis of the venue is
where the tort arose.**SUMMONS****TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:**

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED, to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete is this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

**Dated: Bronx, New York
November 14, 2019**
MICHAEL T. RIDGE, ESQ.
Attorneys for Plaintiffs
**910 GRAND CONCOURSE, STE. 1D
BRONX, NEW YORK 10451
(718) 590-5400**

DEFENDANTS' ADDRESSES:

**CORPORATION COUNSEL
CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007**

**P.O. GRAZIADIO (Tax Registry #966605)
c/o 44th Precinct
2 East 169th Street
Bronx, New York 10452**

**P.O. "JOHN DOE I"
c/o 44th Precinct
2 East 169th Street
Bronx, New York 10452**

LAW OFFICES OF
CHAE T. RIDGE
GRAND CONCOURSE, STE. 1D

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**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**-----X
SAUL ALMONTE,

Plaintiff.

-against-

VERIFIED COMPLAINT**THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GRAZIADIO
(Tax Registry #966605) and P.O. "JOHN DOE I",**Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, by his attorney, **MICHAEL T. RIDGE**, respectfully
allege as follows:

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE

1. That the cause of action herein complained of arose in the County of Bronx, City and State of New York.
2. At all times mentioned, the Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, was and is a municipal corporation duly organized and existing by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. That heretofore and on the August 20, 2019, plaintiff's Notice of Claim and Intention to Sue was duly served upon and filed with **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**.
4. At least thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service of the claim prior to the commencement of this action and adjustment of payment thereof has been neglected or refused, and this action has been commenced within one year and ninety (90) days after the happening of the event upon which the claims are based.
5. That a statutory hearing was held in this matter on or about November 1, 2019, which was prior to the commencement of this action.

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6. Upon information and belief, at all times mentioned, the Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK's** police officers who were involved in this occurrence were and are police officers of the Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, and at all times herein were acting in such capacity as the agents, servants and employees of the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**.

7. On or about July 4, 2019 at approximately 11:30 p.m., the plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, was assaulted and falsely arrested by New York City Police Officers. The events that resulted in the plaintiff's arrest began outside of an apartment building located at 30 East Clarke Place, in the Bronx and continued at the 44th Precinct and in the Courts of the County of the Bronx, City and State of New York.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF
ACTION IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE**

8. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "7" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.

9. On or about July 4, 2019 at approximately 11:30 p.m. the Defendants jointly and severally in their capacity as police officers, wrongfully touched, grabbed, handcuffed and seized the Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, outside of an apartment building located at 30 East Clarke Place, in the Bronx and continued at the 44th Precinct and in the Courts of the County of the Bronx, City and State of New York and done in an excessive manner about hi person, causing him physical pain and mental suffering. At no time did the Defendants have legal cause to grab, handcuff, seize or touch the Plaintiff, nor did the Plaintiff consent to this illegal touching nor was it privileged by law.

**AS AND FOR THE THIRD CAUSE OF
ACTION IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE**

10. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "9" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.

11. On or about July 4, 2019 at approximately 11:30 p.m. the plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, was assaulted and falsely arrested by New York City Police Officers. The events that resulted in the plaintiff's arrest began outside of an apartment building located at 30 East Clarke Place, in the Bronx and continued at 44th Precinct and in the Courts of the County of the Bronx, City and State of New York.

12. The plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, was at the aforementioned location when he was approached and assaulted by members of the New York Police Department namely the defendants, **P.O. GRAZIADIO** and **P.O. "JOHN DOE I."** At the aforementioned time and place, the plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, was falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, abused, assaulted, battered, and caused to sustain serious personal injuries and deprived of his Civil Rights. The Defendant, jointly and severally without any warrant, order or other legal process and without any legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully arrested the Plaintiff, restrained him and his liberty and then took him into custody to the 44th Precinct in the County of the Bronx. The Defendants intentionally confined the Plaintiff without his consent and the confinement was not otherwise privileged by law and, at all times, the Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

**AS AND FOR THE FOURTH CAUSE OF
ACTION IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE**

13. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in paragraphs "1" through "12" as it set forth at length herein.

14. The Defendants, **P.O. GRAZIADIO** and **P.O. "JOHN DOE I"**, were at all times relevant, duly appointed and acting as officers of the City of New York Police Department.

15. At all times mentioned herein, said police officers were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

16. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, is and at all times relevant herein a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

17. The Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, is a municipality duly incorporated under the laws of the State of New York.

18. On or about July 4, 2019 the Defendants, armed police, while effectuating the seizure of the Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the person of the Plaintiff without a court authorized arrest or search warrant. They did physically seize the person of the Plaintiff during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. The Plaintiff was falsely arrested without the Defendants possessing probable cause. In arresting and detaining a claimant against his will by use of a quota system for arrest, which is a practice and customary system used by the New York City Police Department. The plaintiff was arrested through a process of racial profiling employed by New York City Police Department and **P.O. Graziadio and P.O. John Doe I**.

19. The above action of the Defendants resulted in the Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution:

- a. Freedom from summary punishment; and
- b. Freedom from cruel and inhuman punishment; and
- c. Freedom from illegal search and seizure; and
- d. Freedom from false arrest; and

20. The Defendants subjected the Plaintiff to such deprivations, either in a malicious or reckless disregard of the Plaintiff's rights or with deliberate indifference to those rights under the fourth and fourteenth amendments of the United States Constitution.

21. The direct and proximate result of the Defendants' acts are that the Plaintiff has suffered severe and permanent injuries of a psychological nature. He was forced to endure pain and suffering, all to his detriment.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF
ACTION IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE**

22. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, incorporates, repeats and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "21" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.

23. The Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, has grossly failed to train and adequately supervise its police officers in the fundamental law of arrest, search and seizure especially when its police officers are not in possession of a court authorized arrest and a search warrant and where an individual, especially as here, has not committed a crime and has not resisted arrest, that its police officers should only use reasonable force to effectuate an arrest and the arrest should be based on probable cause.

24. The Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, was negligent by failing to implement a policy with its Police Department and instruct police officers who, absent the consent of the Plaintiff (or similarly situated individuals) or without the possession of a court authorized arrest search warrant, said police officers of the City of New York are not to arrest individuals such as the Plaintiff here where probable cause is lacking and the use of force should only be reasonable when an individual resists arrest and should not be used where a criminal defendant is not resisting arrest.

25. **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** is negligent due to its failure to implement a policy with its Police Department or actively enforce the law, if any of the following are lacking:

1. Probable cause must be present before an individual such as the Plaintiff herein can be arrested.
2. Force cannot be used against an individual who does not physically resist arrest.
3. An individual who sustains physical injury at the hands of the police during the arrest process should receive prompt medical attention.

26. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, which caused the police officers to falsely arrest, seize illegally and search the Plaintiff, commit an assault/battery to his person under the belief that they would suffer no disciplinary actions for their failure to take proper or prudent steps in this case.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF
ACTION IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE**

27. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in paragraphs "1" through "26" as if set forth at length herein.

28. The Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, was negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the Police Officer Defendants, the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said Defendants or had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that these officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**,

and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

29. That by reason of the foregoing, this plaintiff was severely injured and damaged, sustained severe nervous shock and mental anguish, emotional upset, has suffered and continued to suffer serious and extreme mental and emotional anguish, distress and psychological damages and difficulties, some of which injuries are permanent in nature and duration, and plaintiff will be permanently caused to suffer pain, inconvenience and other effects of such injuries, plaintiff incurred and in the future will necessarily incur further hospital and/or medical expenses in an effort to be cured of said injuries; and plaintiff will be unable to pursue the usual duties with the same degree of efficiency as prior to this occurrence, all to plaintiff's great damage.

30. The Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, was negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the Police Officer Defendants, the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said Defendants or had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that these officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

31. That by reason of the aforesaid unlawful arrest, the plaintiff was deprived of his liberty, was subjected to great indignity, humiliation, pain and great distress of mind and body and was held up to scorn and ridicule, was injured in his character and reputation, was prevented from attending his usual business and avocation, was injured in his reputation in the community and the said plaintiff has been otherwise damaged.

**AS AND FOR A EIGHTH CAUSE OF
ACTION IN FAVOR OF SAUL ALMONTE**

32. The Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in paragraphs "1" through "31" as if set forth at length herein.

33. The Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, intentionally and maliciously initiated, and actively continued, a criminal judicial proceeding against the plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, without probable cause.

34. That the above mentioned criminal judicial proceeding commenced by the Defendant against the Plaintiff, terminated in the Plaintiff's, favor.

WHEREFORE, the Plaintiff, **SAUL ALMONTE**, demands judgment against the Defendants, together with the costs and disbursements of this action in the amount of damages greater than the jurisdictional limit of any lower Court which would otherwise have jurisdiction. Additionally, Plaintiff demands in respect of all causes of action, punitive damages and attorney fees pursuant to 42 USC Section 1988.

Dated: Bronx, New York
November 14, 2019

Yours, etc.,



MICHAEL T. RIDGE, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
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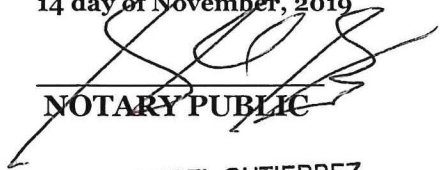
VERIFICATION

STATE OF NEW YORK }
 }s.s.
COUNTY OF BRONX }

SAUL ALMONTE, being duly sworn deposes and says: that deponent is the plaintiff in the within action; that deponent has read the foregoing **SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT** the contents therein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to those matters deponent believes it to be true.

X 
SAUL ALMONTE

Sworn to before me this
14 day of November, 2019


NOTARY PUBLIC

ANGEL GUTIERREZ
Notary Public, State of New York
No. 01GU6174768
Qualified in New York County
Commission Expires October 09, 2023

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SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

MICHAEL T. RIDGE, ESQ.

Attorney for Plaintiff(s)

910 Grand Concourse Suite 1D

Bronx, New York 10451

(718) 590-5400

Dated: Bronx, New York
November 14, 2019

To: *As addressed on attached document.*

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE:

Notice of Entry

☐ that the within is a (*certified*) true copy of a duly entered in the office of the clerk of the within named Court on (*dated*)_____.

Notice of Settlement

☐ that the within order will be presented for settlement to the HON. _____ one of the judges of the within named Court, at (*addr*)_____ on (*dated*)_____.